



Philosophy Honors

CPALMS 2321209010 | Grades 9–12 | Fall Semester | 5 Days/Week | 250 min/week

Family
Course
Overview

Note for Families: This overview reflects the planned course structure. Specific assignments, pacing, and assessments may be adjusted by your teacher. Always refer to your Canvas course for the most current information.

Philosophy Honors introduces students to the great questions of human existence: What can we know? What is real? Does God exist? What is the soul? What makes life meaningful? What is right and wrong? How should society be ordered? Students engage with the major schools of thought from ancient Greece and early modern Europe, reading and analyzing primary philosophical texts, constructing and evaluating arguments, and developing the habits of rigorous, clear thinking. The honors level demands greater depth of analysis, more complex reasoning, and the ability to connect ideas across philosophical traditions.

Semester at a Glance

Quarter 1 — Weeks 1–9

- Wk 1** Invitation to Philosophy: What is Philosophy?
- Wk 2** Philosophical Method: Arguments, Reasoning, and Fallacies
- Wk 3** Epistemology: Rationalism vs. Empiricism and Scientism
- Wk 4** Epistemology: Foundationalism and the Problem of the Criterion
- Wk 5** Metaphysics: The Paradox of Change and Zeno’s Paradoxes
- Wk 6** Metaphysics: Atomism, Plato’s Forms, and Plato’s Dualism
- Wk 7** Metaphysics: Plato’s Allegory of the Cave and Aristotle’s Four Causes
- Wk 8** God: The Idea of God in History and Religious Exclusivism
- Wk 9** God: The Kalam, Anselmian, and Fine-Tuning Arguments; the Problem of Evil

Quarter 2 — Weeks 10–18

- Wk 10** God: Debunking Arguments Against Religious Belief and Responses
- Wk 11** The Soul: Classical Arguments and Materialist Objections
- Wk 12** Meaning: The Soul, the Afterlife, and the Makropulos Case
- Wk 13** Meaning: Fame, Wealth, and the Four Pillars of Happiness
- Wk 14** Ethics: Moral Language; Against Relativism and Nihilism
- Wk 15** Ethics: Virtue, the Cardinal Virtues, and Moral Absolutes
- Wk 16** Political Philosophy: The Common Good and Individualism
- Wk 17** Political Philosophy: Social Contract and Collectivist Theories
- Wk 18** Political Philosophy: Putting It All Together — What is Man?

What a Typical Week Looks Like

Readings & Discussion

- READ** Primary and secondary philosophical texts assigned in Canvas
- DISC** Socratic discussion post engaging a philosophical question, plus substantive replies to classmates

Weekly Time Commitment

- Class meets **5 days/week**, totaling **250 minutes of instruction** per week
- Estimated additional independent work: **1–2 hours/week**
- Discussion posts typically due mid-week; essays and quizzes by Friday

On-Demand Students

Work through modules at your own pace within the semester window. Deadlines appear in Canvas — aim to complete at least one section per day. Reach your teacher via Canvas messages.

Assignments & Assessments

- ANALYSIS** Argument analysis or short philosophical essay connecting readings to the week’s question
- QUIZ** Reading comprehension quiz on assigned texts
- EXAM** Unit exam at the conclusion of each major topic; honors extended response required

What Students Need

- Reliable internet access and a Canvas-compatible device
- A Canvas account (provided by the school)
- Notebook or digital document for notes and argument outlines
- All readings provided in Canvas — no textbook purchase required

Live School Students

Follow a structured weekly schedule with live Socratic sessions. Readings open Monday; discussions due Wednesday; essays and quizzes due Friday. Attend live sessions and check Canvas daily.